

everything carries over. This in addition to full cross-play functionality and shared multiplayer servers means Xbox is making huge progress in the right direction. Of course this isn't limited to just your PC and Xbox. They recently allowed for cross-play between mobile devices and PC for minecraft as well, allowing mobile players to play on PC servers and vice versa.

Cross-platform gaming isn't a new concept, but we feel like it should have



been something that's much more common now, especially with the progress in cloud computing. Sony have taken steps towards cross-platform gaming in the past, allowing for cross-play between the Vita and PlayStation 3 where you could continue your game where you left off on the other console. Additionally, Sony purchased Gaikai, a cloud gaming service in August 2012 for a whopping \$380 million. With big shots like Sony and Xbox going all-in it won't be long before games are as easily accessible as music and movies on the cloud, we're already kind of almost there.

FOR THE PEOPLE, BY THE PEOPLE

Like with any revolution, the renaissance didn't just happen. It's was a combination of both small changes and trends which piled up over time, and all it took was that one push to go over the edge. There's been many trends that have emerged in the recent past that have directed the course of gaming and thankfully, most of these trends are a step in the right direction. Let's briefly touch on each of these trends that now define the course of gaming.

Crowdfunding is one such trend which has taken the world by storm. More and more developers are begin-



Websites like Kickstarter will continue to have game projects because it signifies an important trend of developing games that people really want to play and pay for

ning to embrace crowdfunding and the advantages that come with it. Developers are becoming more transparent with their development process. There are even live-streams of the dev teams in action, showing you how the game is being made from scratch. Now this has several advantages, live streaming in itself is a source of revenue, also being able to closely interact with the people who will probably play your game after you finish it has its perks. For example they could tell you during the development process itself whether they like or dislike something that is within the game, and the devs can address the issue then and there. This also opens the doors for players to actively participate in the creation process. Many games that are crowdfunded on sites like kickstarter and indiegogo allow a select few backers to actually come in and contribute to the development process of the game and their names are even included in the credits.

More and more games are being made which support mods and appease the huge modding community. Just take the Elder Scrolls V: Skyrim Legendary Edition, by allowing even consoles to be able to mod the game,



they're opening up a whole new experience to console gamers. And we're sure that Skyrim is just the first, there will be more console games which will support modding in the future. Another thing to note is the skill and talent of the modders themselves whose mods are studio levels of amazing. It's a great opportunity for them to be able to showcase their stuff on a large scale, and it's not unheard of for modders to get job opportunities with AAA companies.

Another trend that has taken the world by storm is streaming. Twitch has become a second home to some, and watching eSport leagues and tournaments online pulls in more viewers than any other sport on the planet. People are finally beginning to acknowledge eSports and everyone wants to cash in on its popularity. Sports channels like Sky Sports and ESPN already have